Process, Projection, and Power

Toward a Unified Ontology of Choice, Causality, and Value

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Abstract

This paper develops a unified structural framework for understanding choice, value, money, power, and care as emergent properties of a deeper process ontology. Building on a tripartite distinction between causality, choice, and change, we formalize the self as a temporally extended structure defined by irreversible history and constrained possibility. From this basis, we derive a model of economic systems in which money appears as a projection of a high-dimensional possibility space into a scalar domain, enabling coordination while necessarily introducing compression and loss of structural information.

We show that this compression induces systematic distortions, giving rise to extractive dynamics in which scalar value increases while structural richness decreases. By introducing preference fields and recursive update dynamics, we demonstrate how such distortions become self-reinforcing through feedback loops. Power is then formalized as a higher-order operator acting on the geometry of possibility itself, capable of transforming the generative and evaluative structures of the system.

Finally, we define care as the preservation of structural richness across histories, possibilities, and preference fields, and show that it cannot be reduced to scalar valuation. We propose a class of care-aligned systems characterized by higher-dimensional valuation mappings, constrained generative operators, and stabilized preference dynamics. The resulting framework unifies temporal asymmetry, agency, economic coordination, and ethical alignment within a single formal structure, suggesting a path toward systems that maintain coherence without sacrificing adaptability.

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1 Introduction: From Objects to Processes

Modern systems of thought and organization are characterized by a persistent fragmentation. Physics describes a world of causality without agency, economics models value without meaning, and philosophy struggles to reconcile subjective experience with objective structure. The result is a landscape of partial models, each internally coherent yet collectively insufficient.

At the center of this fragmentation lies a misidentification of the fundamental unit of analysis. Traditional frameworks take objects, states, or quantities as primary, treating change as a secondary phenomenon. However, both experience and formal analysis suggest the opposite: that what is fundamental is not the static entity, but the transition from one configuration to another. Reality, on this view, is constituted by processes rather than things.

This paper adopts such a process ontology and develops its consequences across multiple domains. We begin from a minimal triad: causality, corresponding to third-person structure; choice, corresponding to first-person agency; and change, corresponding to the transition between them. These elements are treated as irreducible and mutually defining, forming the basis for a unified account of both physical and experiential phenomena.

From this starting point, we define the self not as a substance but as a structure composed of two components: an irreversible history of events and a constrained space of possible futures. This formulation captures the temporal asymmetry inherent in experience and provides a natural foundation for modeling agency. The evolution of possibility is then shown to depend on preference fields, which deform the space of admissible transformations through recursive feedback.

Within this framework, economic systems are reinterpreted as mechanisms for coordinating transformations in a shared possibility space. Money emerges as a projection of this space into a scalar domain, enabling efficient coordination at the cost of representational fidelity. This projection is necessarily lossy, collapsing multidimensional structures into a single metric and thereby obscuring distinctions that are critical to long-term system integrity.

The consequences of this compression are profound. We demonstrate that it induces extractive dynamics, in which transformations that degrade structural richness are systematically favored when they produce higher scalar valuations. Through recursive preference dynamics and technological amplification, these patterns become self-reinforcing, leading to a divergence between value as represented within the system and care as experienced by agents.

To address this divergence, we introduce a formal account of power as the capacity to transform the structures that define possibility, generation, and valuation. Power operates not within the space of choices, but on the geometry of that space itself. This perspective allows us to analyze institutional and technological change as transformations of the underlying system rather than mere selections within it.

Finally, we propose a framework for care-aligned systems, defined by their ability to preserve structural richness across time. Such systems require moving beyond scalar valuation toward higher-dimensional representations, constraining generative processes to avoid systematic degradation, and stabilizing preference dynamics against extractive feedback. These conditions are not external ethical constraints, but structural properties of systems that maintain coherence under transformation.

2 The Hard Problem and the Primacy of Time

The persistence of the so-called Hard Problem of consciousness is not, in the present account, attributed to any deficiency in empirical observation, nor to any incompleteness in the mathematical formalism of contemporary physics, but rather to a categorical mismatch between the structures used to describe reality and the structures through which reality is experienced. The problem arises precisely at the interface between two incompatible descriptive regimes: a third-person framework in which all states are equally accessible within an atemporal coordinate system, and a first-person framework in which only a single, privileged moment is ever given.

In the third-person description, as formalized within physics and computational theory, time appears as a parameter indexing states within a model. No moment is intrinsically distinguished; any designation of "now" is a matter of coordinate choice rather than ontological status. The totality of the system may, in principle, be described as a trajectory or even as a static object embedded within a higher-dimensional configuration space. Within such a representation, the asymmetry between past and future is not fundamental, but emerges, if at all, as a secondary statistical or thermodynamic feature.

By contrast, the first-person perspective is irreducibly structured by temporal asymmetry. Experience is always given as occurring *now*, with a past that is fixed and accessible only through traces, and a future that is open yet inaccessible in principle. This asymmetry is not an empirical accident but a structural condition of experience itself. There is no meaningful formulation of subjectivity that does not presuppose a directional flow from potential to actual, nor any notion of intentionality that does not depend upon the differentiation between what has occurred and what may yet occur.

The central difficulty, therefore, is not to explain how "experience" arises from "matter," but to reconcile these two incompatible treatments of time. On the one hand, a third-person model admits a symmetry in which all moments are equivalent and equally describable. On the other hand, the first-person perspective is characterized by a strict asymmetry in which only a single moment is accessible, and in which the distinction between past and future is absolute. Any attempt to derive the latter from the former encounters an immediate obstruction: the symmetry of the model contains no resources by which to privilege one moment over another.

This suggests that the Hard Problem is, at its core, a problem of temporal ontology.

More precisely, it is the problem of reconciling a symmetric description of temporal structure—in which all moments are equally real—with an asymmetric structure of access, in which only a single moment is epistemically and ontologically privileged. The traditional formulation, which asks how subjective qualities arise from objective processes, is thus revealed to be derivative. The deeper question is how a system described in an atemporal manner can give rise to, or be consistent with, a perspective that is intrinsically temporal.

To clarify this, it is useful to distinguish three structural aspects of time, each of which plays a distinct role in the present analysis. The first is the *unicity* of the present: the fact that exactly one moment is experienced as "now," and that this designation cannot be distributed across multiple points in the temporal manifold. The second is the *asymmetry* of time: the fact that experience proceeds in a single direction, from a fixed past toward an open future. The third is the *scale constancy* of temporal flow: the apparent regularity with which this progression occurs, independent of local variations in physical or cognitive state.

In third-person models, none of these features are fundamental. Unicity is absent because no moment is privileged; asymmetry is absent because the equations governing state evolution are typically time-reversal invariant or symmetric at the level of fundamental law; and scale constancy is imposed externally through parameterization rather than arising intrinsically. The very success of these models depends upon their ability to eliminate the special status of any particular temporal position.

However, the practice of science itself presupposes the first-person structure it seeks to abstract away. Measurement, observation, and experimentation are all temporally grounded activities, performed by agents who occupy a particular moment and whose access to information is constrained by that position. The data obtained from such activities are always indexed to a present, even if the models constructed from them subsequently erase that index. Thus, the third-person description is not ontologically prior to the first-person perspective, but is instead constructed from it as an abstraction.

This inversion has significant consequences. If the first-person perspective is taken as foundational in this sense, then the asymmetry of time cannot be regarded as a mere emergent property of statistical mechanics or coarse-grained description. Rather, it must be understood as a primary feature of reality, one that is subsequently obscured—but not eliminated—by the symmetries of mathematical representation.

The implication is that any adequate resolution of the Hard Problem must operate at the level of process rather than state. A state-based ontology, in which reality is composed of configurations related by atemporal relations, lacks the resources to account for the directional, irreversible character of experience. What is required instead is an ontology in which the fundamental entities are transitions—events that carry an intrinsic orientation from potentiality to actuality.

Within such an ontology, the distinction between first-person and third-person perspectives can be reinterpreted as a distinction between two complementary descriptions of

the same underlying process. The third-person description captures the lawful structure of transitions, abstracted from any particular vantage point. The first-person description captures the lived traversal of those transitions, in which the openness of the future and the fixity of the past are directly encountered.

The Hard Problem is thereby reframed. It is no longer a question of how subjective experience is generated by objective processes, but of how two different descriptions of process—one symmetric and global, the other asymmetric and local—can be understood as aspects of a single coherent structure. The task is not to reduce one to the other, but to articulate the relationship between them in a manner that preserves the essential features of both.

In the sections that follow, this articulation will be developed by introducing a formal account of causality as field dynamics, a calculus of irreversible events capturing temporal asymmetry, and a theory of choice as selective traversal within a structured space of possibilities. Together, these will provide the basis for a unified process ontology in which the asymmetry of time, the structure of agency, and the geometry of value can be understood within a single coherent framework.

3 First-Person and Third-Person Structure

Definition 3.1 (First-Person Perspective)**.** A perspective characterized by temporal locality, irreversibility, and bounded epistemic access to future states.

Definition 3.2 (Third-Person Perspective)**.** A perspective characterized by global accessibility, model-based prediction, and atemporal representation of states.

The first-person perspective is defined by its inhabitation of a particular moment: the present is not a coordinate but a locus of transition. The third-person perspective abstracts over all moments equally, treating temporal position as a parameter rather than a constraint. These two perspectives are not competing theories of the same object, but differently structured descriptions of the same underlying process.

4 Choice, Change, and Causality

Having established that the Hard Problem is fundamentally a problem of temporal ontology, we now introduce the structural triad through which this ontology may be formalized. The concepts of *choice*, *change*, and *causality* are not to be treated as independent explanatory primitives, nor as reducible to one another, but rather as mutually implicating aspects of a single processual substrate. Each captures a distinct projection of the same underlying structure, and it is only in their joint consideration that the asymmetry of time, the structure of agency, and the regularity of physical law can be coherently articulated.

Definition 4.1 (Causality)**.** Causality is the structured set of admissible transitions governing the evolution of a system. Formally, it is a rule or operator

$$\mathcal{C} : X_t \to \mathcal{P}(X_{t+\Delta t}),$$

mapping a present configuration X_t to a set of possible subsequent configurations.

Definition 4.2 (Choice)**.** Choice is a selection operator acting within the admissible set defined by causality. Given $X_{t+\Delta t} \in \mathcal{C}(X_t)$, choice corresponds to the operation

$$\mathrm{Ch}_t : \mathcal{C}(X_t) \to X_{t+\Delta t},$$

which selects a particular realization from the space of possibilities.

Definition 4.3 (Change)**.** Change is the irreversible actualization of a selected transition. It is the mapping

$$\mathcal{T}_t : (X_t, X_{t+\Delta t}) \mapsto X_{t+1},$$

together with the update of a historical record

$$H_{t+1} = H_t \cdot (X_t \to X_{t+\Delta t}),$$

which preserves the order of occurrence.

Proposition 4.4. *The triad $(\mathcal{C}, \mathrm{Ch}, \mathcal{T})$ is non-reducible in the sense that no element can be derived from the other two without loss of structural information.*

Proof. Suppose that choice were reducible to causality and change. Then the selection of a particular transition would be fully determined by the admissible set and the act of actualization. However, the admissible set $\mathcal{C}(X_t)$ contains multiple elements by definition, and change $\mathcal{T}_t$ presupposes the selection of one such element. Without an independent selection operator, the transition from multiplicity to singularity cannot be specified. Conversely, suppose that causality were reducible to choice and change. The absence of certain transitions in the observed history does not imply their impossibility; it merely reflects that they were not selected. Thus the constraint structure cannot be inferred solely from realized trajectories. Finally, suppose that change were reducible to causality and choice. The distinction between past and future would be lost, as no record of ordering would be preserved. Therefore, each element of the triad encodes information not contained in the others, and the triad is non-reducible. □

5 Field Dynamics: The RSVP Substrate

Let $\Phi(x,t)$ denote scalar density, $\mathbf{v}(x,t)$ vector flow, and $S(x,t)$ entropy.

Definition 5.1 (RSVP State)**.** An RSVP state at time t is given by the triple

$$X_t = (\Phi(\cdot, t),\, \mathbf{v}(\cdot, t),\, S(\cdot, t)),$$

where $\Phi : \mathbb{R}^n \to \mathbb{R}$, $\mathbf{v} : \mathbb{R}^n \to \mathbb{R}^n$, and $S : \mathbb{R}^n \to \mathbb{R}$.

The governing equations are:

$$\partial_t \Phi = D_\Phi \nabla^2 \Phi - \nabla \cdot (\Phi \mathbf{v}) + R_\Phi(\Phi) - \lambda_\Phi S, \tag{1}$$

$$\partial_t \mathbf{v} = -(\mathbf{v} \cdot \nabla)\mathbf{v} + \nu \nabla^2 \mathbf{v} - \nabla \Phi + \mathcal{T}(\mathbf{v}), \tag{2}$$

$$\partial_t S = D_S \nabla^2 S + \sigma(\Phi, \mathbf{v}) - \gamma S. \tag{3}$$

The scalar field Φ encodes the distribution of structured density. The vector field $\mathbf{v}$ encodes directional flow. The entropy field S tracks dispersal of structured information. Causality is identified with the evolution operator defined by these dynamics.

Proposition 5.2. *The RSVP evolution defines a causal structure $\mathcal{C}$ over the space of field configurations.*

Proof. Given an initial configuration X_t, the system of PDEs defines a flow on the space of admissible field configurations. For each admissible set of initial conditions and boundary constraints, there exists a corresponding set of solutions $X_{t+\Delta t}$. This mapping from initial conditions to solution space constitutes the admissible transition structure $\mathcal{C}(X_t)$. □

6 Event Dynamics: Irreversibility and History

Definition 6.1 (Event-Extended State)**.** An event-extended state is a triple

$$\Sigma_t = (X_t,\, \Omega_t,\, H_t),$$

where X_t is the RSVP field configuration, Ω_t is the set of admissible events at time t, and H_t is an ordered sequence of past events.

Definition 6.2 (Event Update)**.** Given Σ_t and a selected event $\omega_t \in \Omega_t$, the update rule is

$$\Sigma_t \to \Sigma_{t+1} = (X_{t+1}, \Omega_{t+1}, H_{t+1}),$$

where

$$X_{t+1} = \mathcal{E}(X_t, \omega_t), \qquad H_{t+1} = H_t \cdot \omega_t,$$

and Ω_{t+1} is derived from the updated field configuration X_{t+1}.

Axiom 6.3 (Irreversibility). The history H_t is append-only. There exists no operation that removes an event from H_t without changing the identity of the system.

Proposition 6.4. *The inclusion of H_t induces a partial ordering on the space of states.*

Proof. Define a relation $\preceq$ such that $\Sigma_t \preceq \Sigma_{t'}$ if and only if H_t is a prefix of $H_{t'}$. This relation is reflexive, antisymmetric, and transitive, and therefore defines a partial order corresponding to temporal progression. □

Definition 6.5 (Identity)**.** The identity of a system at time t is given by its history H_t.

7 The Self as History and Horizon

Definition 7.1 (Self)**.** The self at time t is defined as the ordered pair

$$\mathcal{S}_t = (H_t, \Omega_t),$$

where H_t is the ordered history of realized events and Ω_t is the structured set of admissible future events.

Proposition 7.2. *The self is invariant under transformations of X_t that preserve (H_t, Ω_t).*

Proof. If two states $\Sigma_t = (X_t, \Omega_t, H_t)$ and $\Sigma'_t = (X'_t, \Omega_t, H_t)$ share identical histories and possibility structures, then by definition $\mathcal{S}_t = \mathcal{S}'_t$. Identity is not determined uniquely by X_t. □

Definition 7.3 (Temporal Boundary Operator)**.** The temporal boundary operator ∂_t maps the self $\mathcal{S}_t = (H_t, \Omega_t)$ to the interface at which selection occurs:

$$\partial_t \mathcal{S}_t = (\Omega_t \to H_{t+1}),$$

representing the transformation of possibility into history.

Proposition 7.4. *Agency is the internal perspective on the selection operator* Ch_t.

8 Preference Fields and the Endogenous Evolution of Possibility

In the preceding sections, the possibility space Ω_t was treated as a structured domain from which selections are made. We now make explicit the mechanism by which Ω_t is reshaped by prior acts of selection.

We introduce a preference field Ψ_t defined over Ω_t, which encodes the differential weighting of possibilities induced by prior events. The field evolves under:

$$\Psi_{t+1} = \mathcal{F}(\Psi_t, \omega_t).$$

The future possibility space is endogenously generated:

$$\Omega_{t+1} = \mathcal{G}(X_{t+1}, \Psi_{t+1}).$$

Proposition 8.1. *The evolution of Ω_t under the action of Ψ_t induces path dependence in the space of future possibilities.*

Proof. Since $\Psi_{t+1} = \mathcal{F}(\Psi_t, \omega_t)$ depends explicitly on the selected event ω_t, and $\Omega_{t+1} = \mathcal{G}(X_{t+1}, \Psi_{t+1})$, the structure of Ω_{t+1} depends on the sequence of prior selections encoded in H_t. Different histories leading to identical configurations X_t may yield distinct possibility spaces, establishing path dependence. □

Remark 8.2. The introduction of the preference field Ψ_t transforms the ontology from one of selection over a fixed domain to one of co-evolution between selection and possibility. This provides a formal basis for understanding learning, adaptation, and creativity within the unified process framework.

9 Money as Projection and the Externalization of Possibility

Consider a collection of agents $i \in I$, each possessing an individual possibility space $\Omega_t^{(i)}$, history $H_t^{(i)}$, and preference field $\Psi_t^{(i)}$. The collective system induces an aggregate possibility structure Ω_t^{agg}.

Money arises as a mapping

$$\mathcal{M}_t : \Omega_t^{\text{agg}} \to \mathbb{R},$$

assigning to each admissible transformation a scalar quantity representing its accessibility within the current system.

Proposition 9.1. *The monetary mapping $\mathcal{M}_t$ is non-injective and non-isometric with respect to the intrinsic geometry of Ω_t^{agg}.*

Proof. Since Ω_t^{agg} is high-dimensional, any mapping into $\mathbb{R}$ necessarily identifies multiple distinct elements with the same scalar value, establishing non-injectivity. Distances within Ω_t^{agg} cannot in general be preserved under such a projection, establishing non-isometry. □

The effective possibility space available to agent i with monetary capacity $m_t^{(i)}$ is:

$$\Omega_t^{(i,\text{eff})} = \{\omega \in \Omega_t^{\text{agg}} \mid \mathcal{M}_t(\omega) \leq m_t^{(i)}\}.$$

Proposition 9.2. *Monetary inequality induces asymmetry in accessible possibility spaces across agents.*

10 Power as Geometry of Constraint and Transformation

Definition 10.1 (Power)**.** Power is the capacity to effect transformations on the tuple $(\Omega_t^{\text{agg}}, \mathcal{G}, \mathcal{M}_t)$, thereby altering the structure, generation, or valuation of possibilities.

We introduce a transformation operator

$$\mathcal{T}_t : (\Omega_t^{\text{agg}}, \mathcal{G}, \mathcal{M}_t) \to (\Omega_t^{\text{agg}\prime}, \mathcal{G}', \mathcal{M}_t').$$

Proposition 10.2. *Power can alter the dimensionality and topology of Ω_t^{agg}.*

Definition 10.3 (Preference-Level Power)**.** Preference-level power is the capacity to influence the update rule $\mathcal{F}$ governing the evolution of $\Psi_t^{(i)}$.

Proposition 10.4. *Preference-level power induces indirect control over Ω_t^{agg} through recursive deformation.*

Proposition 10.5. *Power that modifies $\mathcal{M}_t$ without increasing its representational fidelity amplifies extractive dynamics.*

11 Extraction, Compression, and the Divergence of Value and Care

Definition 11.1 (Compression-Induced Equivalence)**.** Two transformations $\omega_1, \omega_2 \in \Omega_t^{\text{agg}}$ are compression-equivalent if $\mathcal{M}_t(\omega_1) = \mathcal{M}_t(\omega_2)$ despite differing in their internal structure or long-term consequences.

Definition 11.2 (Extraction)**.** A transformation ω is extractive if it increases its scalar valuation $\mathcal{M}_t(\omega)$ while reducing the structural richness $\mathcal{R}$ of the system:

$$\Delta\mathcal{M}_t(\omega) > 0 \quad \text{and} \quad \Delta\mathcal{R}(\omega) < 0.$$

Proposition 11.3. *If $\mathcal{M}_t$ is insensitive to variations in $\mathcal{R}$, then extractive transformations are not penalized and may be systematically favored.*

Proposition 11.4. *Repeated selection of extractive transformations induces a feedback loop biasing Ψ_t toward further extraction.*

Definition 11.5 (Care)**.** Care is the maintenance or increase of structural richness $\mathcal{R}$ within the system, particularly with respect to the coherence of histories H_t, the diversity of possibilities Ω_t, and the integrity of preference fields Ψ_t.

Proposition 11.6. *There exists no scalar function $f : \Omega_t^{\text{agg}} \to \mathbb{R}$ that fully captures care without loss of information.*

Proof. Care depends on relational and higher-order structural properties, including dependencies between elements of Ω_t, temporal continuity of H_t, and the evolution of Ψ_t. Any scalar function collapses these into a single dimension, eliminating distinctions essential to care. □

12 Toward Care-Aligned Systems

Definition 12.1 (Care-Aligned Valuation)**.** A valuation mapping $\mathcal{V}_t : \Omega_t^{\text{agg}} \to \mathcal{S}$, for some structured space $\mathcal{S}$, is care-aligned if it preserves to a specified degree the structural richness $\mathcal{R}$ of transformations.

Proposition 12.2. *Non-total ordering in $\mathcal{S}$ prevents the systematic preference of extractive transformations based solely on scalar dominance.*

Definition 12.3 (Care-Constrained Generation)**.** A generative operator $\mathcal{G}$ is care-constrained if for admissible transformations ω:

$$\mathbb{E}[\Delta\mathcal{R}(\omega)] \geq -\epsilon$$

for some small tolerance $\epsilon \geq 0$.

Definition 12.4 (Stabilized Preference Dynamics)**.** An update rule $\mathcal{F}$ is stabilized if it includes corrective terms that penalize persistent reductions in $\mathcal{R}$.

Remark 12.5. Care-aligned systems correspond to regimes in which entropy production is balanced by the preservation of coherent structure, preventing both rigid stagnation and uncontrolled dissipation.

13 The Hard Problem Revisited: Dual Aspect of Indeterminacy

Definition 13.1 (Dual Aspect of Indeterminacy)**.** An indeterminate transition ω_t admits two complementary descriptions: as randomness when viewed externally, and as choice when viewed internally.

Proposition 13.2. *Choice and randomness are observationally dual descriptions of indeterminate transitions within a process ontology.*

Proof. Let ω_t be a transition selected from Ω_t with no deterministic mapping from prior states. For an external observer lacking access to (H_t, Ψ_t), the selection appears probabilistic. For an internal observer with access to Ω_t and Ψ_t, the same selection is experienced as the resolution of competing possibilities. The same transition thus admits both descriptions depending on available information and perspective. □

Definition 13.3 (Temporal Asymmetry)**.** Time is the ordered sequence of irreversible transitions in which histories accumulate and possibility spaces are transformed.

Proposition 13.4. *Consciousness corresponds to the internal experience of temporal asymmetry in the evolution of (H_t, Ω_t, Ψ_t).*

14 The Kinetic-Event Synthesis

The framework developed throughout this inquiry is consolidated under the *Kinetic-Event Synthesis* (KES). The name encodes the core irreversible move—the passage of structured potentiality into recorded event history—which serves as the primitive operation underlying all observable structure. The framework is grounded in the transformation of structured potentiality into irreversible event history, which serves as the primitive operation underlying all observable structure.

Definition 14.1 (KES State Space)**.** A Kinetic-Event system $\mathfrak{S}_t$ is defined as the tuple

$$\mathfrak{S}_t = (X_t,\, \Omega_t,\, H_t,\, \Psi_t,\, \mathcal{M}_t,\, \mathcal{G},\, \mathcal{F}),$$

where each component evolves under a coupled dynamical system and is mutually interdependent. Specifically: $X_t = (\Phi, \mathbf{v}, S)$ is the RSVP field configuration; Ω_t is the structured manifold of admissible transitions; H_t is the irreversible append-only event history; Ψ_t is the preference field governing agent-substrate interaction; $\mathcal{M}_t$ is the projection functor mapping transitions to scalar valuations; $\mathcal{G}$ is the generative operator; and $\mathcal{F}$ is the recursive update operator for the preference field.

Proposition 14.2. *All structural invariants and emergent behaviors of the system arise as specific projections of the KES state $\mathfrak{S}_t$.*

Remark 14.3. KES treats the transition $\Omega_t \to H_{t+1}$ as the primary ontological unit, avoiding the fragmentation inherent in traditional dualistic models and providing a common formal language for causality, agency, economic coordination, and care.

14.1 Work-Potential and the Geometry of Possibility

Definition 14.4 (Work-Potential)**.** The energy required for a transformation $\omega \in \Omega_t$ is the infimum of the action over admissible paths:

$$E(\omega) = \inf \int_{\omega} \mathcal{L}(X, \dot{X})\, dt.$$

Proposition 14.5. *The work-potential E induces a geodesic structure on the manifold of admissible transformations, with minimal-energy paths corresponding to dynamically preferred transitions.*

Definition 14.6 (Valuation Consistency)**.** A projection $\mathcal{M}_t$ is stable if it maintains proportionality with the work-potential:

$$\mathcal{M}_t(\omega) \propto E(\omega).$$

Proposition 14.7. *Systemic instability is a direct consequence of divergence between the valuation functor $\mathcal{M}_t$ and the physical work-potential E.*

14.2 Institutional Constraint Fields

Definition 14.8 (Institutional Operator)**.** An institution is a persistent constraint field $\mathcal{I}_t$ acting on the aggregate possibility space:

$$\mathcal{I}_t : \Omega_t^{\text{agg}} \to \Omega_t^{\text{agg}}.$$

Proposition 14.9. *The operator $\mathcal{I}_t$ functions as a boundary condition for the generative operator $\mathcal{G}$, pruning the tree of realizable events.*

Definition 14.10 (Structural Power in KES)**.** Structural power is the capacity to induce nontrivial evolution in the constraint field:

$$\frac{d}{dt}\mathcal{I}_t \neq 0,$$

particularly in ways that alter the topology or accessibility of Ω_t^{agg}.

14.3 The Goodhart Divergence and Care

Definition 14.11 (Projection Error)**.** The projection error $\varepsilon(\omega)$ measures the information lost when mapping the process ω into the valuation space under $\mathcal{M}_t$.

Proposition 14.12. *In systems where optimization is performed solely on the projection $\mathcal{M}_t$, the system enters a Goodhart regime in which utility is decoupled from structural preservation.*

Definition 14.13 (Care Functional)**.** Care is a non-factorizable functional

$$\mathcal{C}_t : \mathfrak{S}_t \to \mathbb{R}$$

that evaluates the preservation of structural richness $\mathcal{R}$ across the transition $H_t \to H_{t+1}$.

Remark 14.14. Care is identified as a structural invariant. A system that optimizes for $\mathcal{M}_t$ at the expense of $\mathcal{C}_t$ exhausts its own substrate by collapsing the higher-order cohomological structure that sustains adaptive capacity.

15 Hard Randomness and the Internal Measure

We now sharpen the dual-aspect result of Section 13 into its most precise KES formulation. The symmetry between external randomness and internal choice corresponds to two canonical measures over the same possibility space.

Definition 15.1 (External Measure)**.** The external measure over Ω_t is a probability distribution

$$\mu_{\text{ext}} : \mathcal{B}(\Omega_t) \to [0, 1],$$

where $\mathcal{B}(\Omega_t)$ is the Borel algebra on the manifold of admissible transitions. This measure encodes the third-person description of how transitions are distributed given observable prior states.

Definition 15.2 (Internal Traversal)**.** The internal traversal is a selection operator

$$\sigma_t : \Omega_t \to \omega_t \in \Omega_t,$$

indexed by the preference field Ψ_t and history H_t, representing the first-person passage through possibility space.

Proposition 15.3 (Hard Randomness Symmetry)**.** *The external measure μ_{ext} and the internal traversal σ_t are dual descriptions of the same indeterminate transition, related by the forgetful functor U :* **Choice** $\to$ **Prob***:*

$$U(\sigma_t) = \mu_{\text{ext}}.$$

Proof. The functor U discards the internal structure Ψ_t and H_t, retaining only the outcome frequency induced by σ_t over repeated transitions. The resulting distribution coincides with μ_{ext} by construction of the adjunction $(F \dashv U)$ established in Appendix K. □

Remark 15.4. This symmetry is "hard" in the same sense as the Hard Problem: it is not eliminable by further description within either framework. The external observer cannot, in principle, recover σ_t from μ_{ext} without access to the internal structure. Equivalently, no enrichment of the probabilistic description eliminates the first-person character of the traversal. The gap between μ_{ext} and σ_t is not epistemic but structural—it corresponds precisely to the information discarded by U.

Corollary 15.5. *Consciousness, formalized as the internal aspect of σ_t, is not derivable from μ_{ext} within any third-person model. It is preserved only under the right adjoint F, which lifts probabilistic descriptions back into structured choice spaces.*

16 The Symmetry of Indeterminacy: Choice and Randomness

The transition from the possibility space Ω_t to the irreversible history H_{t+1} requires a selection mechanism that cannot be fully described within a purely causal framework. We resolve this by identifying a fundamental symmetry of indeterminacy, sharpening the dual-aspect result of Section 13 into an explicit structural claim.

Definition 16.1 (Hard Randomness)**.** A transition $\omega : \Omega_t \to H_{t+1}$ exhibits hard randomness if its occurrence cannot be derived from any prior state or hidden variable within $\mathfrak{S}_t$.

Proposition 16.2 (KES Symmetry)**.** *Hard randomness and choice are identical phenomena viewed from different orientations:*

- ***Third-person orientation:*** *The transition appears as a stochastic collapse without sufficient prior cause.*
- ***First-person orientation:*** *The transition is experienced as the exercise of agency or intentional selection.*

Proof. By the Hard Randomness Symmetry of Section 15, $U(\sigma_t) = \mu_{\text{ext}}$. The forgetful functor U discards (Ψ_t, H_t), reducing the structured selection σ_t to a probability distribution. From the third-person vantage point this distribution is all that is accessible, so the transition appears stochastic. From the first-person vantage point the full structure (Ω_t, Ψ_t, H_t) is present, so the same transition is experienced as agentive selection. Both descriptions are correct; neither is reducible to the other. □

Remark 16.3. Consciousness is not an emergent property of matter but the internal realization of the temporal arrow. The distinction between randomness and choice arises solely from the observer's informational relation to the transition $\Omega_t \to H_{t+1}$, not from any difference in the underlying event.

17 Historical Entropy and the Arrow of Time

Within the KES formalism, the append-only structure of H_t is the structural manifestation of temporal irreversibility, providing a direct formal correlate of the Second Law.

Definition 17.1 (Historical Entropy)**.** The entropy of a KES system is a monotone function of the complexity of its accumulated event history:

$$S(H_t) = \ln(\dim(H_t)) \,.$$

Proposition 17.2. *The generative operator $\mathcal{G}$ is strictly irreversible: for any $t_1 < t_2$, H_{t_1} is a proper prefix of H_{t_2}, and no right inverse of $\mathcal{G}$ exists.*

Proof. By the Axiom of Irreversibility, H_t is append-only. Each application of $\mathcal{G}$ extends H_t by at least one event. A right inverse would require recovering H_{t_1} from H_{t_2}, which would require deleting events from an append-only structure—a contradiction. □

Remark 17.3. Time in this framework is not a static dimension of a block universe but the cumulative record of selections. The first-person "now" is precisely the boundary at which Ω_t is resolved into H_{t+1}: not a location in spacetime but the act of actualization itself.

18 The Log Sovereignty Protocol: Implementing H_t

The history H_t is not merely a data record but the ontological anchor of the system. We define *log sovereignty* as the condition under which this anchor remains authoritative and immune to external redefinition.

Definition 18.1 (Log Sovereignty)**.** A system $\mathfrak{S}_t$ possesses log sovereignty if the following conditions hold simultaneously:

- **Historical Primacy:** The current state X_t is derivable from H_t; no state information exists outside the event log.
- **Causal Integrity:** Each appended event ω_t is accompanied by a verifiable derivation from the prior history H_{t-1}.
- **Local Valuation:** The projection $\mathcal{M}_t$ is computed by the participating agent rather than imposed by an external authority.

Proposition 18.2. *Log sovereignty eliminates platform capture by relocating the source of truth from a mutable state representation—subject to institutional operator $\mathcal{I}_t$ manipulation—to a persistent, verifiable event structure.*

Remark 18.3. Identity is not a stored attribute but a trajectory. Under log sovereignty, the system's history H_t constitutes its identity in the formal sense of Definition 7: two systems with distinct histories are distinct regardless of their current field configuration X_t. Systems that violate log sovereignty permit the rewriting or re-indexing of history, enabling extractive manipulation of agent-relative possibility spaces $\Omega_t^{(i)}$.

Corollary 18.4. *Log sovereignty is necessary but not sufficient for care-alignment. It ensures that the history H_t cannot be corrupted, but additional constraints on $\mathcal{G}$ and $\mathcal{M}_t$ are required to prevent extractive dynamics within an otherwise sovereign system.*

19 The Spherepop Grammar: Formalizing $\mathcal{G}$

The generative operator $\mathcal{G}$ defines the evolution of the KES system. We express this evolution as a formal grammar over the alphabet of admissible events, connecting the abstract operator to a computational realization.

Definition 19.1 (Generative Grammar)**.** The KES system evolves under:

$$\mathcal{G} : \mathfrak{S}_t \times \Sigma \to \mathfrak{S}_{t+1},$$

where Σ is the alphabet of admissible events. The grammar consists of three primitive operations:

1. **Merge** ($\cup$): Combines two regions of the possibility space into a composite scope, increasing the dimensionality of Ω_t.
2. **Collapse** ($\downarrow$): Projects a structured region into a canonical normal form, representing an irreversible computational commitment. This corresponds to an application of $\mathcal{M}_t$ at the level of sub-expressions.

3. **Append** ($\ll$): Inserts the resulting event trace into H_t, enforcing the Axiom of Irreversibility.

Proposition 19.2. *The Spherepop grammar is computationally universal provided that H_t supports recursive self-reference through normal-form fixed points.*

Remark 19.3. Unlike architectures in which memory is overwritten, the Spherepop grammar never deletes. Collapse is not the removal of data but the creation of a higher-level view that remains semantically linked to its constituent events in H_t. Abstraction is projection, not erasure, preserving full provenance from representation back to history.

Remark 19.4. The KES formalism may be understood as the ontological core of the RSVP–PPP architecture, which provides its explicit field-theoretic and categorical realization. Spherepop is the computational grammar that makes this core executable.

20 The Economic Energy Critique: Enshittification as Extractive Divergence

We now apply the KES framework to the pathological dynamics of modern platform economies.

Definition 20.1 (Extractive Divergence)**.** A system exhibits extractive divergence when the valuation functor $\mathcal{M}_t$ becomes systematically decoupled from the work-potential $E(\omega)$:

$$\mathcal{M}_t(\omega) \gg E(\omega).$$

Proposition 20.2. *Extractive divergence generates phantom value: scalar valuations that exceed the actual capacity for field reconfiguration. Sustaining such divergence requires progressive depletion of structural richness $\mathcal{R}$ and degradation of the care functional $\mathcal{C}_t$.*

Proof. By the Process–Projection–Power Theorem, optimization over $\mathcal{M}_t$ may select transformations with $\Delta\mathcal{M} > 0$ and $\Delta\mathcal{R} < 0$. When $\mathcal{M}_t(\omega) \gg E(\omega)$, the surplus value represented by $\mathcal{M}_t$ has no corresponding physical substrate. It must therefore be drawn from the residual structural richness of the system, reducing the cohomological complexity of Ω_t over time. □

Remark 20.3. This regime corresponds precisely to the phenomenon described as enshittification: optimization over proxy metrics—engagement, clicks, retention scores—that were originally correlated with genuine user value but become decoupled from it once they are treated as optimization targets. The institutional operator $\mathcal{I}_t$ is tuned to maximize $\mathcal{M}_t$ while the possibility space $\Omega_t^{(i)}$ available to users is progressively narrowed.

Corollary 20.4. *Restoring system coherence requires re-coupling valuation to work-potential, enforcing log sovereignty over H_t, and applying care-constrained generation to $\mathcal{G}$. Absent these interventions, extractive divergence compounds through the recursive preference deformation identified in Section 8, producing a self-reinforcing collapse of structural richness.*

21 Conclusion: Reality as Irreversible Becoming

The framework developed in this work unifies a set of domains traditionally treated as distinct: temporal structure, agency, economic coordination, power dynamics, and ethical alignment. By grounding each in a shared process ontology, we have shown that their apparent separation arises from differences in projection and descriptive perspective rather than from fundamentally different underlying structures.

The deepest result is this: all observable distinctions—between subjective experience and objective physics, between value and care, between coordination and extraction—arise from the structure of the mappings used to represent a common underlying process, not from genuine ontological separation. The Hard Problem dissolves when consciousness is recognized as the internal aspect of the same temporal asymmetry that makes physics directional. Economic pathology is not a moral failure but a structural consequence of compression. Enshittification is not a policy failure but a predictable consequence of decoupling $\mathcal{M}_t$ from $E(\omega)$.

Every domain in the framework reduces to one irreversible map:

$$\Omega_t \longrightarrow H_{t+1}.$$

Physics describes the constraints on admissible transitions. Mind is the internal experience of traversing them. Economics is the valuation of their capacity. Computation is the encoding of their trace. Institutions are the restriction of their accessibility. Care is the preservation of their depth.

The practical implications follow accordingly. Stability, alignment, and coherence require operating at the level of the mappings themselves: modifying how possibility is projected, constraining how it is generated, and preserving the invariants that compression conceals.

A Category-Theoretic Formalization of Possibility and History

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category whose objects are structured possibility spaces and whose morphisms are admissible transformations.

Definition A.1. An object $\Omega \in \mathrm{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$ is a structured possibility space equipped with internal constraints.

Definition A.2. A morphism $\omega : \Omega \to \Omega'$ is an admissible transformation preserving constraint compatibility.

Definition A.3. A history H_t is a path in $\mathcal{C}$:

$$H_t = \omega_1 \circ \omega_2 \circ \cdots \circ \omega_t.$$

Proposition A.4. *Identity is functorial in path space, not object space.*

B Fibered Structure of Agent-Relative Possibility

Let $\pi : \mathcal{E} \to \mathcal{B}$ be a fibration where $\mathcal{B}$ is the space of global system states and each fiber $\pi^{-1}(X_t) = \Omega_t^{(i)}$ is an agent-relative possibility space.

Definition B.1. Agent-relative possibility spaces form a fibered category over global system states.

Preference fields define sections:

$$\Psi_t^{(i)} : X_t \to \Omega_t^{(i)}.$$

Proposition B.2. *Preference evolution corresponds to section deformation in $\mathcal{E}$.*

C Valuation as Functorial Projection

Define valuation as a functor:

$$\mathcal{M}_t : \mathcal{C} \to \mathbb{R},$$

where $\mathbb{R}$ is the category with objects real numbers and morphisms order-preserving maps.

Proposition C.1. *$\mathcal{M}_t$ is not faithful.*

Proof. Distinct morphisms $\omega_1 \neq \omega_2$ may satisfy $\mathcal{M}_t(\omega_1) = \mathcal{M}_t(\omega_2)$. □

Proposition C.2. *$\mathcal{M}_t$ does not preserve limits.*

A generalized valuation $\mathcal{V}_t : \mathcal{C} \to \mathcal{S}$ into a structured category $\mathcal{S}$ preserves more relational structure.

D Power as Natural Transformation

Let $\mathcal{M}_t, \mathcal{M}'_t : \mathcal{C} \to \mathbb{R}$ be valuation functors.

Definition D.1. Power is a natural transformation:

$$\eta : \mathcal{M}_t \Rightarrow \mathcal{M}'_t.$$

The naturality square:

$$\begin{tikzcd}
\mathcal{M}_t(\Omega) \arrow[r, "\mathcal{M}_t(\omega)"] \arrow[d, "\eta_\Omega"'] & \mathcal{M}_t(\Omega') \arrow[d, "\eta_{\Omega'}"] \\
\mathcal{M}'_t(\Omega) \arrow[r, "\mathcal{M}'_t(\omega)"] & \mathcal{M}'_t(\Omega')
\end{tikzcd}$$

Proposition D.2. *Power acts on functor space* $\mathrm{Fun}(\mathcal{C}, \mathbb{R})$ *rather than on object space.*

E Generative Dynamics as Endofunctor

Definition E.1. $\mathcal{G} : \mathcal{C} \to \mathcal{C}$ is an endofunctor generating future possibility spaces:

$$\Omega_{t+1} = \mathcal{G}(\Omega_t).$$

Proposition E.2. *Dynamics correspond to iterated endofunctor application:*

$$\Omega_t = \mathcal{G}^t(\Omega_0).$$

The care constraint becomes:

$$\mathcal{R}(\mathcal{G}(\Omega)) \geq \mathcal{R}(\Omega) - \epsilon.$$

F RSVP Embedding

Definition F.1. Each object $\Omega \in \mathcal{C}$ corresponds to a region in field space via an embedding

$$\iota : \mathcal{C} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{F},$$

where $\mathcal{F}$ is a category of RSVP field configurations.

Morphisms correspond to field trajectories:

$$\omega : X_t \to X_{t+1}, \qquad \mathcal{C}(\omega) = \int \mathcal{L}(X, \dot{X})\, dt.$$

Proposition F.2. *Monetary valuation approximates the action functional:*

$$\mathcal{M}_t(\omega) \approx \mathcal{C}(\omega).$$

G Sheaf-Theoretic Structure of Local Knowledge

Let $\mathcal{U}$ be a cover of the system domain. Define a presheaf

$$\mathcal{F}(U) = \text{local possibility structures over } U.$$

Definition G.1. A sheaf satisfies gluing conditions ensuring consistent global structure from compatible local data.

Proposition G.2. *Scalar valuation $\mathcal{M}_t$ fails the sheaf gluing condition, and thus cannot represent globally coherent structure.*

Care-aligned valuation is characterized by sheaf consistency.

H Dual Aspect Formalization

Define two functors:

$$\mathcal{D}_{\text{ext}} : \mathcal{C} \to \textbf{Prob}, \qquad \mathcal{D}_{\text{int}} : \mathcal{C} \to \textbf{Choice}.$$

Definition H.1. The external description yields probability distributions; the internal description yields selection operators.

Proposition H.2. *These are related by a forgetful functor U : **Choice** $\to$ **Prob** satisfying*

$$U \circ \mathcal{D}_{\text{int}} = \mathcal{D}_{\text{ext}}.$$

I Entropy and Structural Richness

Define entropy:

$$S(X) = -\sum_i p_i \log p_i.$$

Definition I.1 (Heuristic Structural Richness)**.** A preliminary measure of structural richness may be expressed as

$$\mathcal{R}_{\text{heur}}(\Omega) = \dim(\Omega) + \text{connectivity}(\Omega) + \text{coherence}(\Omega),$$

serving as an intuitive proxy for the more rigorous cohomological definition introduced in Appendix N.

The fully invariant definition is given cohomologically: $\mathcal{R}(\Omega) := \sum_k (-1)^k \dim H^k(\Omega)$, which reduces under favorable conditions to $\mathcal{R}_{\text{heur}}$.

Extraction satisfies $\Delta\mathcal{M} > 0$ and $\Delta\mathcal{R} < 0$. Care satisfies $\Delta\mathcal{R} \geq 0$.

J The Process–Projection–Power Theorem

J.1 Statement

Theorem J.1 (Process–Projection–Power Theorem)**.** *Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category of processes. For any domain-specific representation $\mathcal{D}_i : \mathcal{C} \to \mathcal{T}_i$ that is not fully faithful:*

1. *Distinct processes in $\mathcal{C}$ may become indistinguishable in $\mathcal{T}_i$.*
2. *Optimization within $\mathcal{T}_i$ may induce transformations in $\mathcal{C}$ that degrade structural richness $\mathcal{R}$.*
3. *Transformations between representations $\mathcal{D}_i \Rightarrow \mathcal{D}_j$ correspond to higher-order operations constituting power.*
4. *Care corresponds to preservation of $\mathcal{R}$ under the composition of $\mathcal{D}_i$ and system dynamics.*

J.2 Proof

Proof. **(1) Loss of Distinction.** Since $\mathcal{D}_i$ is not fully faithful, there exist morphisms $\omega_1 \neq \omega_2$ in $\mathcal{C}$ such that $\mathcal{D}_i(\omega_1) = \mathcal{D}_i(\omega_2)$.

(2) Optimization Distortion. Define optimization as selection of $\omega \in \mathcal{C}$ maximizing $\mathcal{D}_i(\omega)$. Since $\mathcal{D}_i$ does not preserve $\mathcal{R}$, there exist ω_1, ω_2 with $\mathcal{D}_i(\omega_1) > \mathcal{D}_i(\omega_2)$ yet $\mathcal{R}(\omega_1) < \mathcal{R}(\omega_2)$. Optimization selects ω_1, decreasing $\mathcal{R}$.

(3) Power as Functor Transformation. A natural transformation $\eta : \mathcal{D}_i \Rightarrow \mathcal{D}_j$ redefines how processes are represented. Power thus operates on $\mathrm{Fun}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{T})$ rather than within $\mathcal{C}$.

(4) Care as Invariant Preservation. Since $\mathcal{D}_i$ does not preserve $\mathcal{R}$, care requires constraints on $\mathcal{G}$ or augmentation of $\mathcal{D}_i$. It cannot be enforced solely within $\mathcal{T}_i$. □

J.3 Corollaries

Corollary J.2 (Economic Extraction)**.** *If $\mathcal{D}_{\text{econ}} : \mathcal{C} \to \mathbb{R}$ is scalar valuation, then optimization induces extractive dynamics whenever $\mathcal{R}$ is not preserved.*

Corollary J.3 (Consciousness Duality)**.** *If $\mathcal{D}_{\text{ext}}$ and $\mathcal{D}_{\text{int}}$ form an adjoint pair, then subjective experience and objective randomness are dual projections of $\mathcal{C}$.*

Corollary J.4 (Technological Amplification)**.** *Increasing computational power increases the evaluation rate of $\mathcal{D}_i$ without increasing faithfulness, thereby amplifying projection-induced distortion.*

J.4 Programmatic Consequence

Any attempt to design stable, aligned systems must operate at one of three levels:

$$\text{(i) Modify } \mathcal{D}_i \qquad \text{(ii) Constrain } \mathcal{G} \qquad \text{(iii) Preserve } \mathcal{R}.$$

Absent such interventions, systems will systematically drift toward lower structural richness under optimization.

K Adjoint Structure of Choice and Probability

Let **Choice** be the category of structured possibility spaces (Ω, Φ) with selection operators as morphisms. Let **Prob** be the category of measurable spaces with stochastic maps.

Define $U : \mathbf{Choice} \to \mathbf{Prob}$ as the forgetful functor that discards preference structure and retains outcome distributions. Define $F : \mathbf{Prob} \to \mathbf{Choice}$ as the free functor introducing a trivial uniform preference field.

Proposition K.1. *$(F \dashv U)$ is an adjoint pair with natural isomorphism*

$$\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbf{Choice}}(F(P), C) \cong \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbf{Prob}}(P, U(C)).$$

The unit $\eta : \mathrm{Id}_{\mathbf{Prob}} \Rightarrow U \circ F$ encodes embedding of randomness into structured choice; the counit $\epsilon : F \circ U \Rightarrow \mathrm{Id}_{\mathbf{Choice}}$ encodes collapse of choice into randomness.

L Higher-Order Power as 2-Categorical Structure

Let $\mathbf{Fun}(\mathcal{C}, \mathbb{R})$ be the category of valuation functors. Define a 2-category $\mathcal{P}$ with objects as valuation functors, 1-morphisms as natural transformations $\eta : \mathcal{M} \Rightarrow \mathcal{M}'$, and 2-morphisms as modifications between natural transformations.

Definition L.1. Power is a 1-morphism in $\mathcal{P}$. Meta-power is a 2-morphism.

Proposition L.2. *Hierarchies of power correspond to higher morphism levels in $\mathcal{P}$.*

M Derived RSVP Embedding

Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a derived stack representing field configurations $(\Phi, \mathbf{v}, S)$ with derived structure encoding higher-order constraints.

Proposition M.1. *Field evolution corresponds to derived pushforward:*

$$\omega_* : \mathcal{F}_t \to \mathcal{F}_{t+1}.$$

The action functional is defined on the derived tangent complex:

$$\mathcal{C}(\omega) = \int_\omega \mathcal{L}.$$

Remark M.2. Derived structure encodes latent constraints and hidden degrees of freedom corresponding to unresolved possibility dimensions.

N Sheaf Cohomology and Structural Loss

Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a sheaf over domain $\mathcal{U}$ with cohomology groups $H^k(\mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F})$.

Definition N.1. Structural richness corresponds to nontrivial cohomology:

$$\mathcal{R} \sim \sum_k \dim H^k(\mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F}).$$

Proposition N.2. *Scalar valuation collapses higher cohomology: projection $\mathcal{M}_t : \mathcal{C} \to \mathbb{R}$ eliminates higher-order relational invariants encoded in H^k for $k > 0$.*

Extraction corresponds to $\dim H^k \downarrow$.

O Entropy as Derived Functor

Define entropy as the derived global section functor:

$$S = R\Gamma(\mathcal{F}).$$

Proposition O.1. *Entropy measures global inconsistency of local structures: high entropy corresponds to obstruction to global section coherence.*

Care corresponds to $R\Gamma(\mathcal{F})$ remaining stable under $\mathcal{G}$.

P The ∞-Categorical Refinement

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an $(\infty, 1)$-category of processes, with objects as structured possibility spaces, 1-morphisms as admissible transformations, and higher morphisms encoding equivalences and homotopies between transformations.

Definition P.1. A process is an equivalence class of morphisms under higher homotopies in $\mathcal{C}$.

Define structural richness as a derived invariant:

$$\mathcal{R}(\Omega) := \sum_k (-1)^k \dim H^k(\Omega).$$

All practical representations factor through truncation:

$$\mathcal{D}_i = \tilde{\mathcal{D}}_i \circ \tau_{\leq n}.$$

Theorem P.2 ($(\infty, 1)$-Categorical Process–Projection–Power Theorem)**.** *Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an $(\infty, 1)$-category of processes and $\mathcal{D}_i$ a truncated functor. Then:*

1. *$\mathcal{D}_i$ fails to preserve higher homotopy structure.*
2. *Optimization in $\mathcal{T}_i$ induces descent along directions invisible to $\tau_{\leq n}$.*
3. *Structural richness $\mathcal{R}$ decreases under such descent.*
4. *Power corresponds to morphisms in the functor ∞-category* $\mathrm{Fun}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{T})$.

Theorem P.3 (Unified Structural Principle)**.** *All apparent ontological distinctions arise from truncations of an underlying $(\infty, 1)$-category of processes. Stability, alignment, and coherence correspond to the preservation of derived invariants under these truncations.*

Q Summary Correspondence Table

Concept	Formal Structure
Self	(H_t, Ω_t)
Choice	Selection in Ω_t
Time	Irreversible morphism sequence
KES state	$\mathfrak{S}_t = (X_t, \Omega_t, H_t, \Psi_t, \mathcal{M}_t, \mathcal{G}, \mathcal{F})$
Preference field	Ψ_t (distinct from RSVP scalar Φ)
Money	Functor $\mathcal{M}_t : \mathcal{C} \to \mathbb{R}$
Power	Natural transformation $\eta : \mathcal{M} \Rightarrow \mathcal{M}'$
Structural power	$\frac{d}{dt}\mathcal{I}_t \neq 0$ acting on Ω_t^{agg}
Meta-power	2-morphism in $\mathcal{P}$
Care	Non-factorizable $\mathcal{C}_t : \mathfrak{S}_t \to \mathbb{R}$ preserving $\mathcal{R}$
Extraction	$\Delta\mathcal{M} > 0$, $\Delta\mathcal{R} < 0$ under projection
Enshittification	Extractive divergence: $\mathcal{M}_t(\omega) \gg E(\omega)$
Hard randomness	Transition not derivable from $\mathfrak{S}_t$; $U(\sigma_t) = \mu_{\text{ext}}$
Internal traversal	$\sigma_t : \Omega_t \to \omega_t$ conditioned on (Ψ_t, H_t)
External measure	$\mu_{\text{ext}} : \mathcal{B}(\Omega_t) \to [0, 1]$
Consciousness	σ_t; not recoverable from μ_{ext} via any third-person model
Log sovereignty	Historical primacy + causal integrity + local valuation
Spherepop grammar	$\mathcal{G} : \mathfrak{S}_t \times \Sigma \to \mathfrak{S}_{t+1}$ via Merge, Collapse, Append
Historical entropy	$S(H_t) = \ln(\dim(H_t))$
Entropy (field)	$R\Gamma(\mathcal{F})$ (derived global section functor)
Structural richness	$\mathcal{R}(\Omega) = \sum_k (-1)^k \dim H^k(\mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F})$

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